

procedure, removing the directory location and choosing a drive letter instead. The data on the drive will be unharmed.

Running Older Software On XP

 XP can be set to mimic various OS environments for a program. If you have a program that simply refuses to work on XP, give this a try: after installing the application, right-click on the exe file or on the shortcut to it, and select 'Properties.' Choose the 'Compatibility' tab. The first section in this window, 'Compatibility mode', covers mimicking various OS environments to try and make your application more comfortable.

You can also set the program to run in 256 colours and/or 640 x 480 resolution, which many older software titles require.

'No To All' When Copying Files

 Have you noticed that XP gives you the 'Yes to all' option in its file copy dialog box, which is useful if you would like to overwrite files in a directory with newer files of the same name from another location, but fails to offer a 'No to all' option for doing the opposite? Annoying, if you think about it.

What if you have a lengthy file copy operation partially finished, and wish to restart it? If you use the default options, you essentially have to recopy every file, since saying 'No' to every duplicate file will take just as long.

Fortunately, there's a way to tell XP not to copy all duplicated files, with a single command.

To do this, when the file copy dialog box appears asking you whether you wish to overwrite the first file, hold down [Shift] and click 'No'. This will automatically answer 'No' for all the files that follow!

Note, however, that XP will ask you again for the first new folder it encounters. Follow the same procedure to answer 'No' automatically for all the folders.

Create A Link To Shut Down Your PC

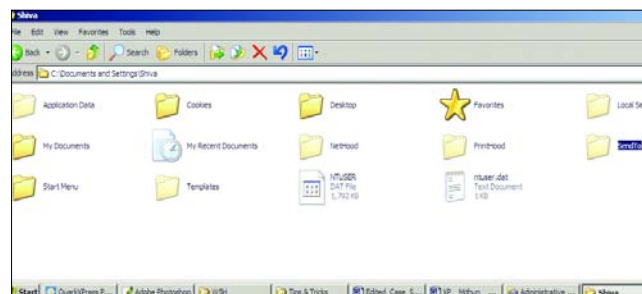
 To create a useful link desktop link to shut down or restart your PC, right-click on an empty area of your desktop, and select **New > Shortcut** to open the 'New Shortcut' wizard.

When prompted for the location of the shortcut, enter "shutdown -s -t 01" to shut down the system, or "shutdown -r -t 01" to restart the system. Name the shortcut and give it an appropriate icon from the '%SystemRoot%\system32\SHL32.dll' location.

Add Items To 'Send To'

 First enable the viewing of hidden files and folders. XP, like previous versions of Windows, has a handy 'Send to' option in the menu that appears when you right-click an icon in Windows Explorer.

By default, this contains only a few options, none of which are particularly useful except for creating shortcuts.



The 'Send to' folder can be viewed only if you choose to view hidden folders and files

However, you can easily add your own destinations to the 'Send to' menu. Very useful if you have a folder you use for backing up files, for example, and you want to periodically move different files or folders to a location.

To add items to the 'Send to' command, navigate to 'C:\Documents and

Settings\Username\Send to'.

Any shortcuts to folders or applications placed in this folder will appear in the 'Send to' option when you right-click an icon.

Block Incoming Attacks Without A Firewall

 Limit your exposure to attacks from the cyber world by blocking incoming connections. Go to **Start > Settings > Control Panel > Network Connections**. Right click on 'Local Area Network' and go to 'Properties'.

In the scroll box, click on 'Internet Protocol (IP/TCP)' and then click 'Properties'; in the new window, click 'Advanced'.

Then in the other new window go to the 'Options' tab, click on 'TCP/IP Filtering' and hit 'Properties'. Uncheck 'Enable TCP/IP filtering (all adapters)'.

Next, in the above 'TCP Ports', check the radio button that reads 'Permit Only', and then add in the ports you want people to be able to access.

This way, you close the ports you don't need. An alternative to this tweak could be running a firewall or enabling Windows' inbuilt firewall.

regarding your surfing habits and are impossible to delete using normal deletion methods. Even deleting your cookies and the history file retains these index.dat files.

To delete them, you'll need to first reboot your computer. Go to the advanced booting options by pressing [F8] or [F5]. You'd now need to choose 'Safe mode with command prompt'; log in as Administrator and then delete these files.

You delete them by going to the root and typing in "del index.dat /s". This will delete all the 'index.dat' files on your computer.

Convert FAT32 Partitions To NTFS

 To change from a FAT 32 to NTFS file system for more stability, security and less fragmentation, open the command prompt and type in "convert C:/FS:NTFS", with C being the drive you wish to convert. Make sure there's a space between the "C:" and the forward slash. Once you press [Enter], it will ask you for a confirmation; press [Y]. Then press [Y] and [Enter] once more to reboot. This works for all versions of Windows XP.

Decrease System Loading Time By Changing Your Network Settings

 When you start up your computer while you are connected to a LAN, and your computer is set to DHCP, it has to search for the DHCP server and then request an IP address and all other configurations.

This process takes some time and slows down the time it takes to boot the computer up. Following the directions below will help you set a static IP address.

Even if your ISP asks you to use DHCP this tweak may still work for you. Go to **Start > Run**, type in "cmd" and click OK.

At the DOS prompt, type in "ipconfig". This will show you the current IP addresses that your NIC and PPPoE adapters have. Take note of

Completely Remove Index.dat

 Index.dat files store all the information